



△ Napoleon at the Battle of Austerlitz

1805

FRENCH VICTORIOUS AT AUSTERLITZ

After a dismal defeat by the British at Trafalgar on 21 October, Napoleon secured one of his most brilliant victories against the Russians and Austrians at Austerlitz on 2 December. With tactical genius and hard fighting, Napoleon outwitted a much larger enemy force. Austria was forced to make peace and the anti-French Third Coalition was broken.

1808-14 The Peninsular War pits France against Spain, Portugal, and Britain

1810-26

LATIN AMERICAN WARS OF INDEPENDENCE

After 300 years of Spanish rule, all of Spain's American colonies except Cuba and Puerto Rico gained independence between 1810 and 1826, largely through the leadership of Simón Bolívar in the north of South America and José San Martín in the south. They converged in Peru and Bolivia, forcing the last Spanish troops to leave South America in 1826.



▽ José San Martín, Battle of Chacabuco, Chile, 1817

1805

1807 Britain abolishes the slave trade (although slavery itself remains legal); the US enacts a similar ban in 1808

1810 MEXICAN WAR OF INDEPENDENCE

On 16 September 1810, the priest Miguel Hidalgo y Costilla issued a revolutionary tract known as the *Grito de Dolores* (Cry of Dolores), calling for the end of Spanish rule in Mexico. A peasant army gathered around Hidalgo, nearly capturing Mexico City before being defeated at the Battle of Calderón Bridge in January 1811. More uprisings followed, leading to the establishment of a short-lived empire and, in 1823, the Republic of Mexico.



▷ Miguel Hidalgo's *Cry of Dolores*, mural